

Performing a Credentialed Scan Using Nessus

Objective: To perform a credentialed scan on a Windows Server using Nessus and generate a vulnerability report

Tools required: None

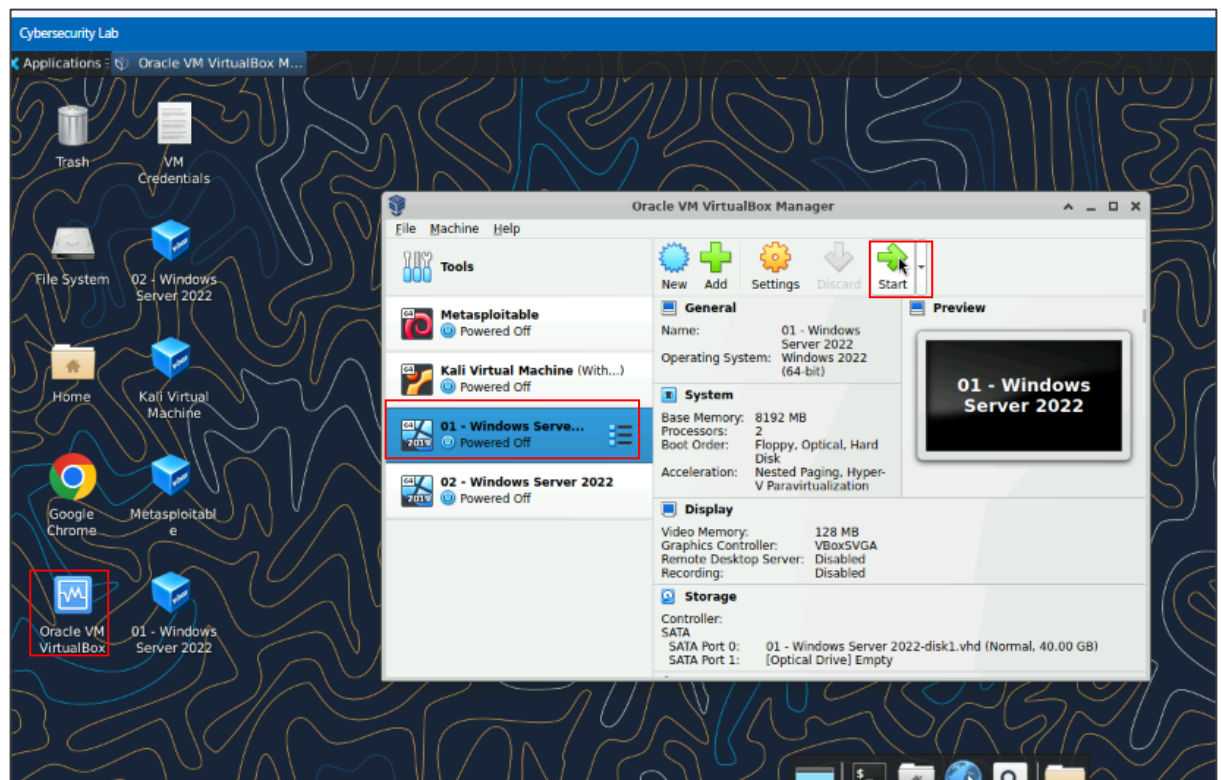
Prerequisites: Nessus must be installed.

Steps to be followed:

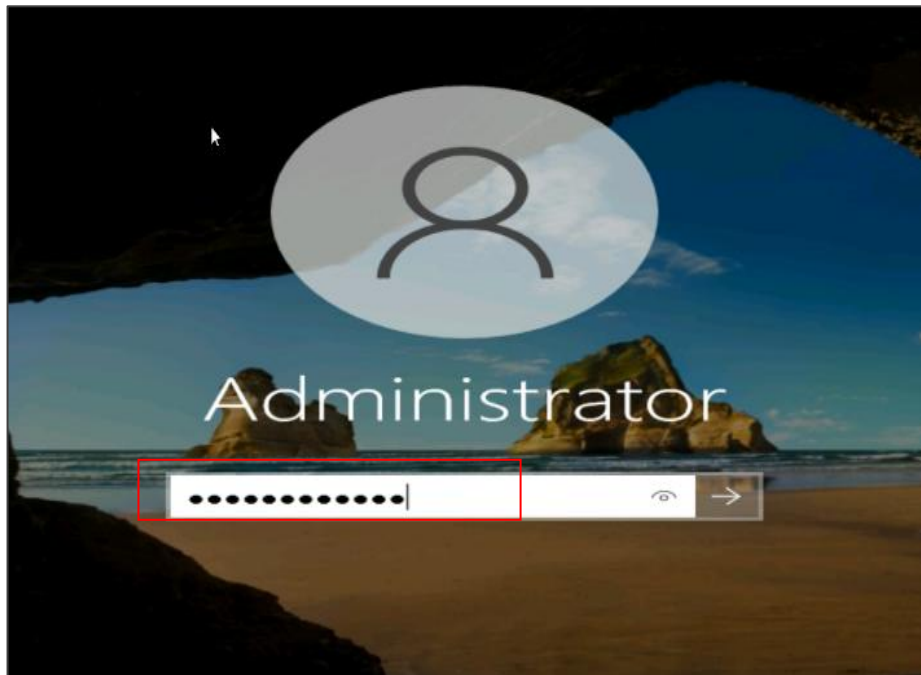
1. Scan credentials using Nessus
2. Generate the report

Step 1: Scan credentials using Nessus

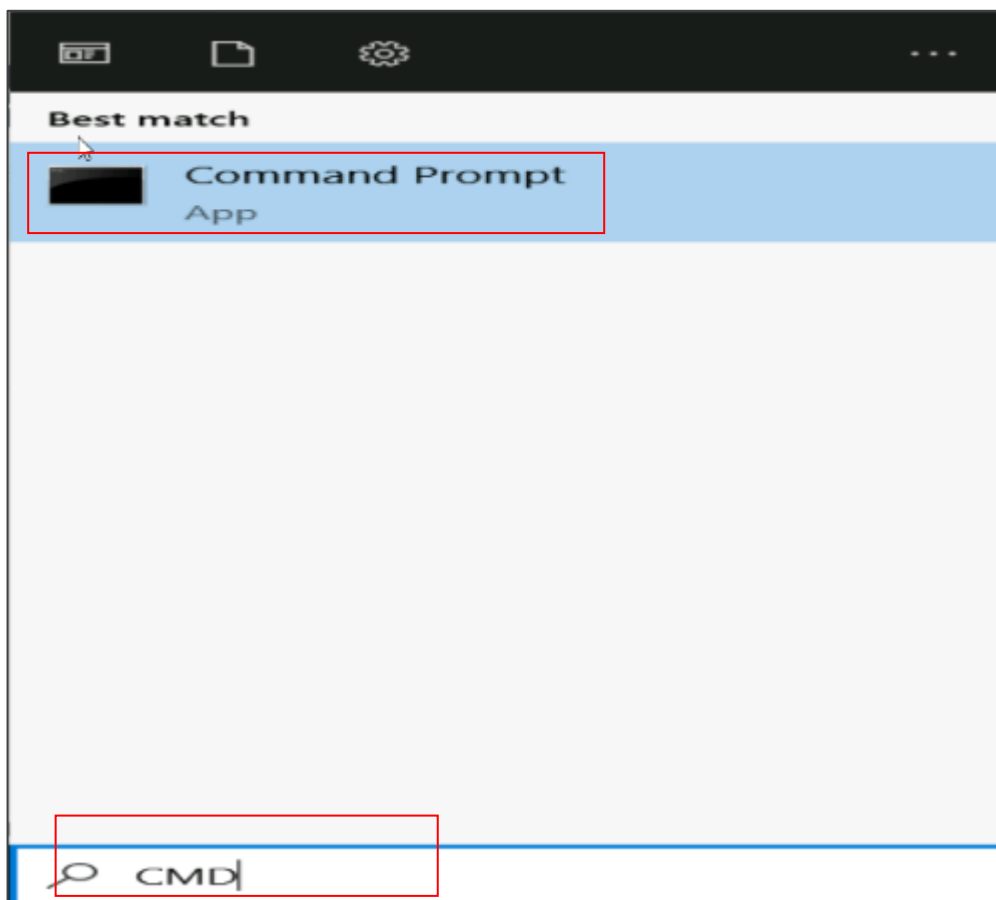
- 1.1 Double-click on the **Oracle VM VirtualBox**, select the **01 – Windows Server 2022** and click **Start**



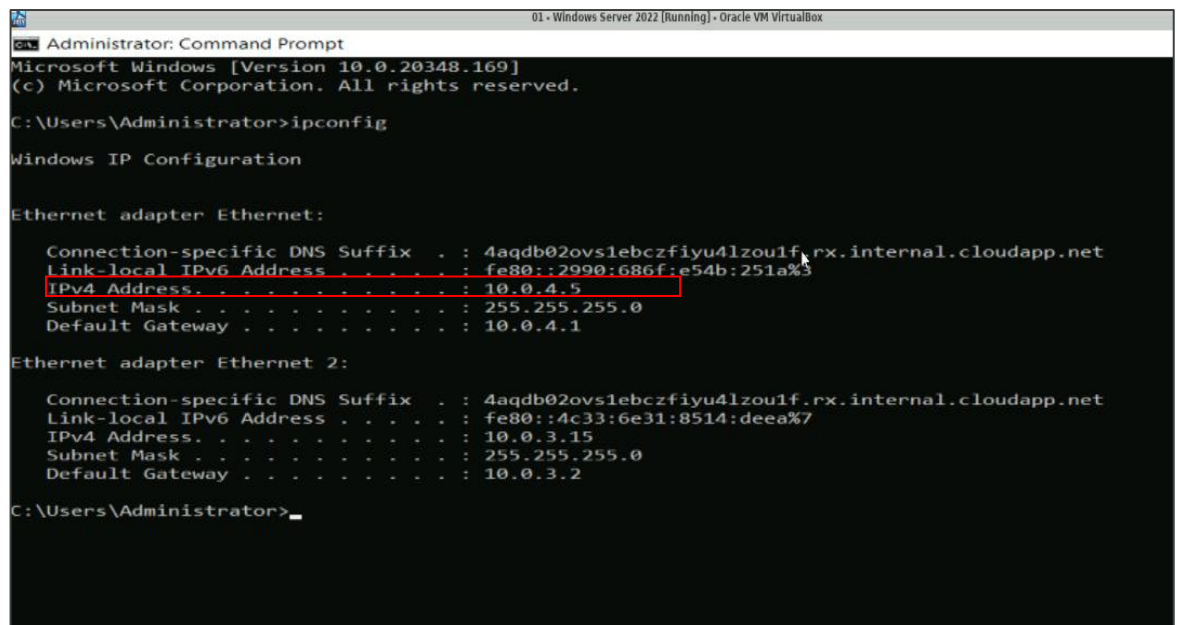
1.2 Enter the password as **Password.1!!** and press enter



1.3 Open the Search box, type **CMD**, and open the **Command Prompt**



1.4 Run the command **ipconfig** to retrieve the server's IP address



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Administrator: Command Prompt
Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.20348.169]
(c) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved.

C:\Users\Administrator>ipconfig

Windows IP Configuration

Ethernet adapter Ethernet:

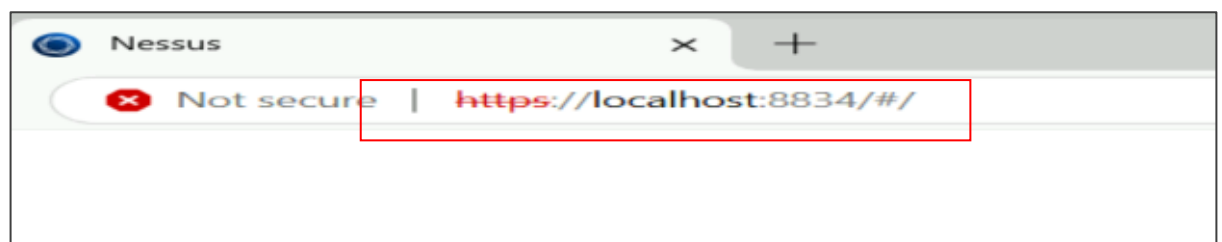
    Connection-specific DNS Suffix  . : 4aqdb02ovs1ebczfiyu4lzou1f.rx.internal.cloudapp.net
    Link-local IPv6 Address . . . . . : fe80::2990:686f:e54b:251a%3
    IPv4 Address. . . . . : 10.0.4.5
    Subnet Mask . . . . . : 255.255.255.0
    Default Gateway . . . . . : 10.0.4.1

Ethernet adapter Ethernet 2:

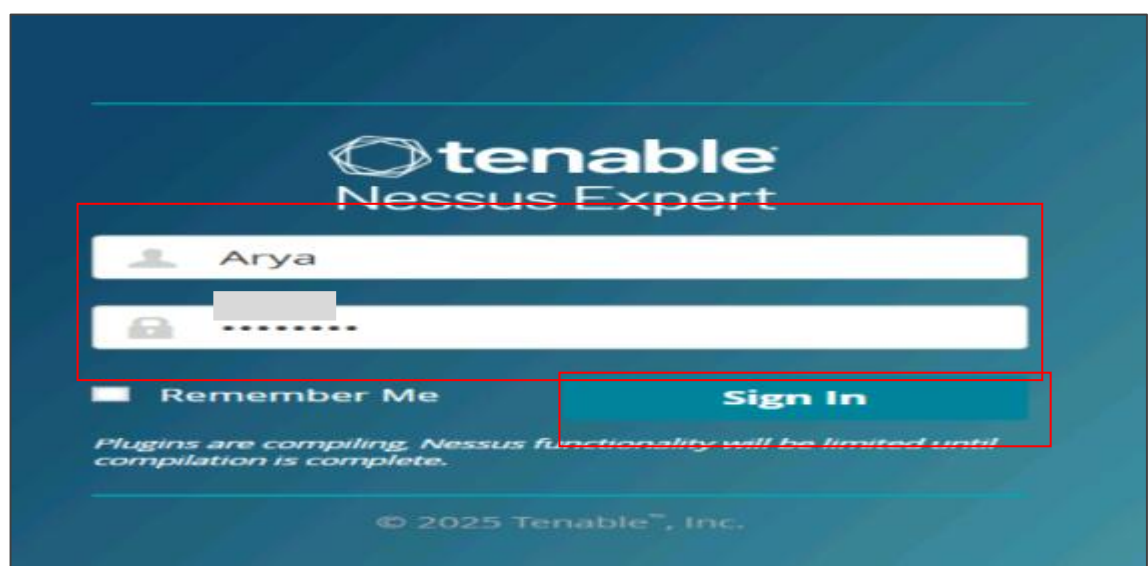
    Connection-specific DNS Suffix  . : 4aqdb02ovs1ebczfiyu4lzou1f.rx.internal.cloudapp.net
    Link-local IPv6 Address . . . . . : fe80::4c33:6e31:8514:deea%7
    IPv4 Address. . . . . : 10.0.3.15
    Subnet Mask . . . . . : 255.255.255.0
    Default Gateway . . . . . : 10.0.3.2

C:\Users\Administrator>
  
```

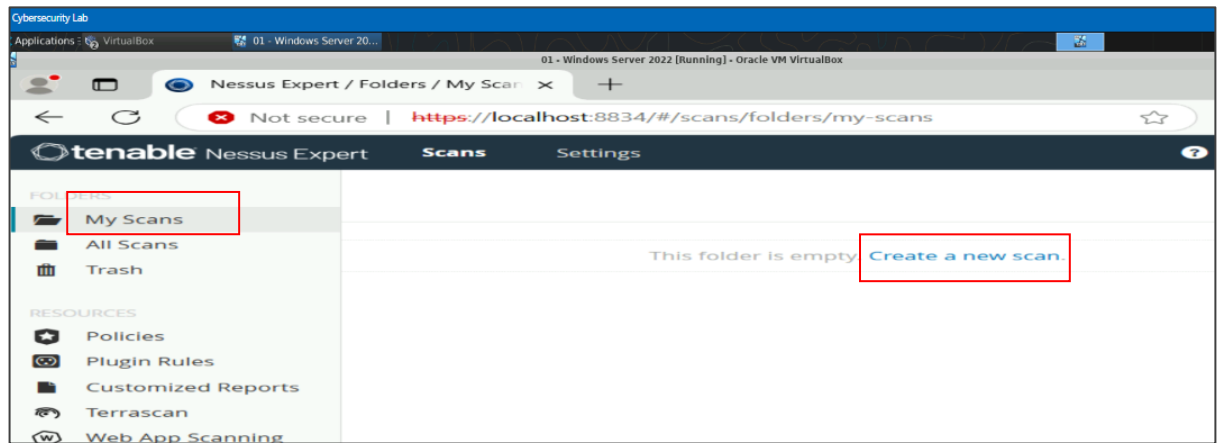
1.5 Launch the Microsoft Edge browser and navigate to **http://localhost:8834**



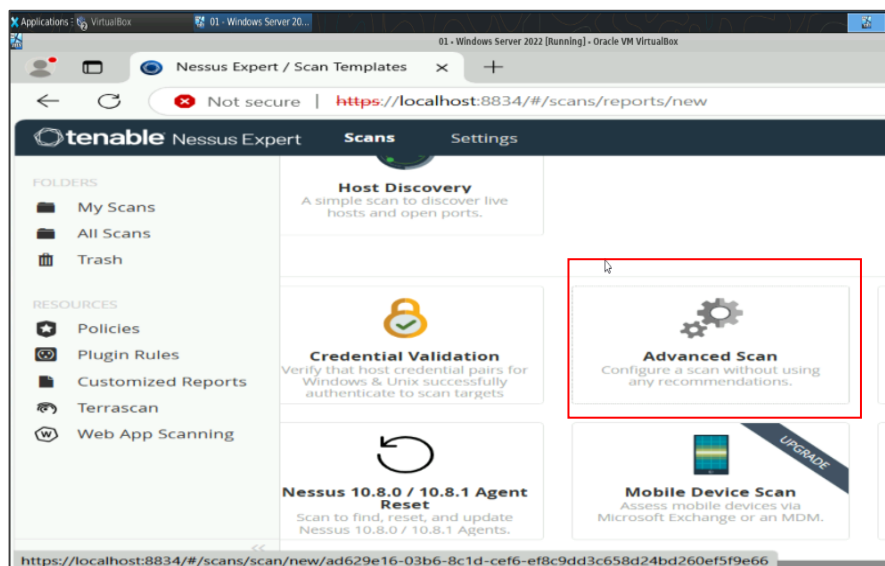
1.6 **Sign In** to Nessus using the provided username and password



1.7 Navigate to the **My Scans** section and click on **Create a new scan**



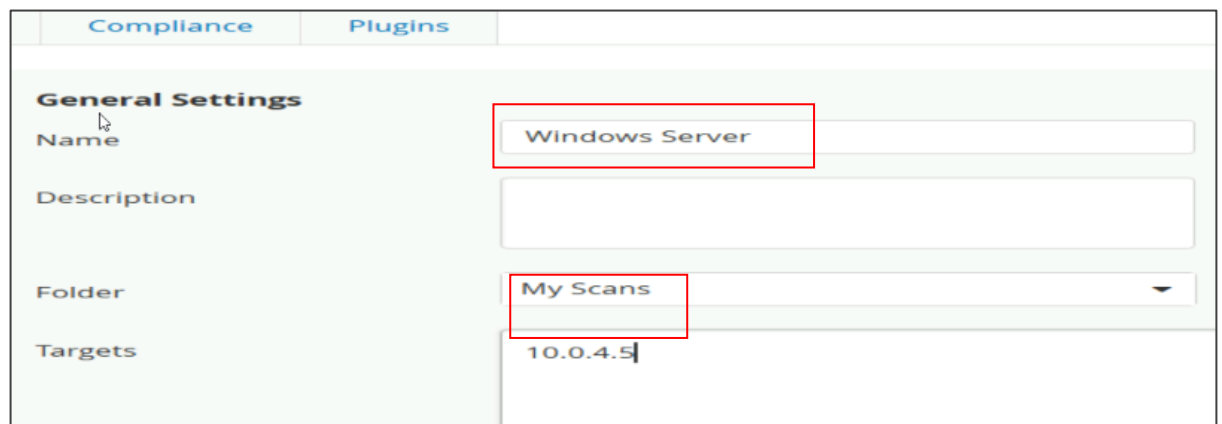
1.8 Select **Advanced Scan** from the available options



1.9 Provide the following details:

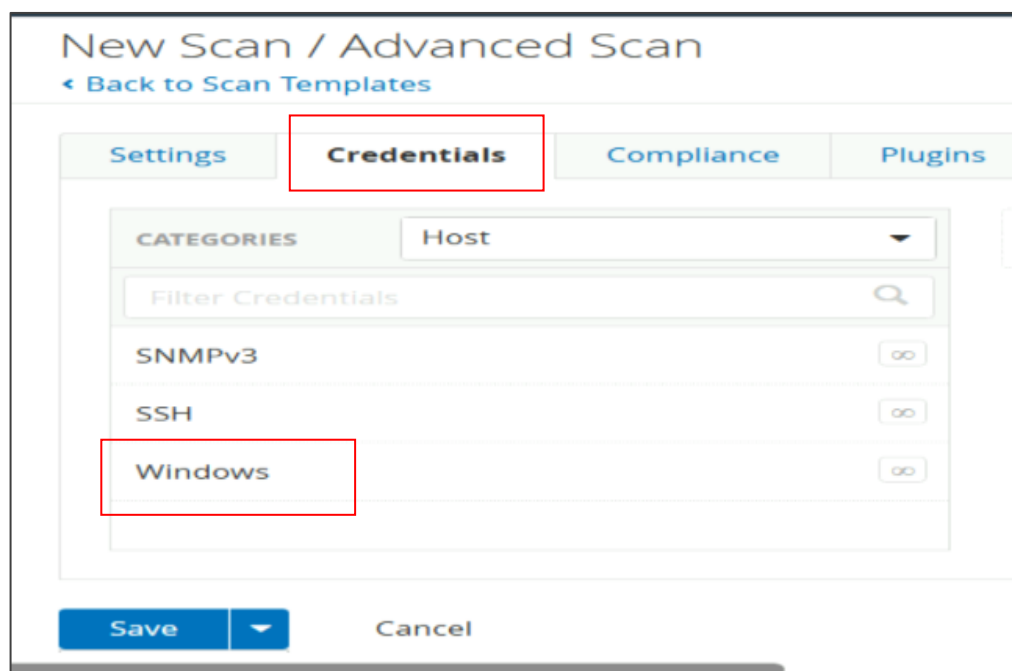
Scan Name: Windows Server

Targets: Enter the target machine's IP address that you have fetched from step 1.4



Compliance	Plugins
General Settings	
Name	Windows Server
Description	
Folder	My Scans
Targets	10.0.4.5

1.10 Navigate to the **Credentials** tab and select **Windows** as the type



New Scan / Advanced Scan

[← Back to Scan Templates](#)

Settings	Credentials	Compliance	Plugins
CATEGORIES Host Filter Credentials SNMPv3 SSH Windows			

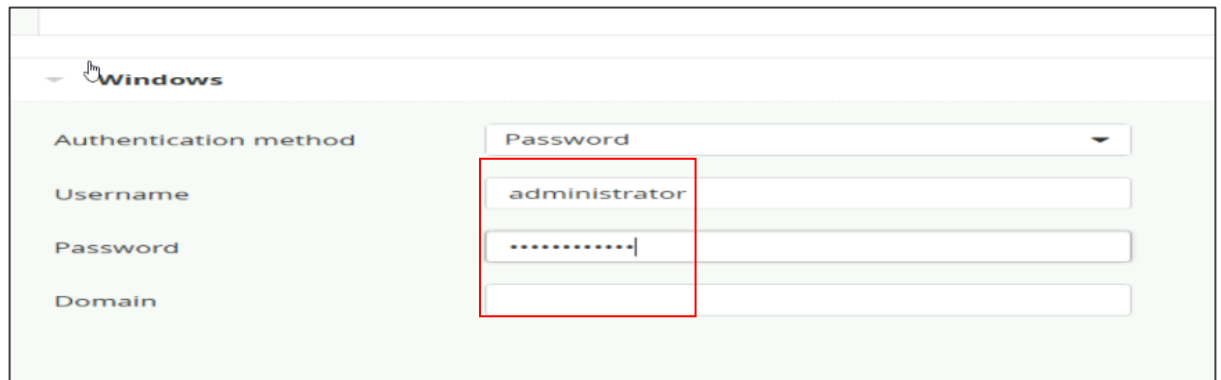
Save
Cancel

1.11 Configure the credentials:

Authentication Method: Password

Username: administrator

Password: Password.1!!



Windows

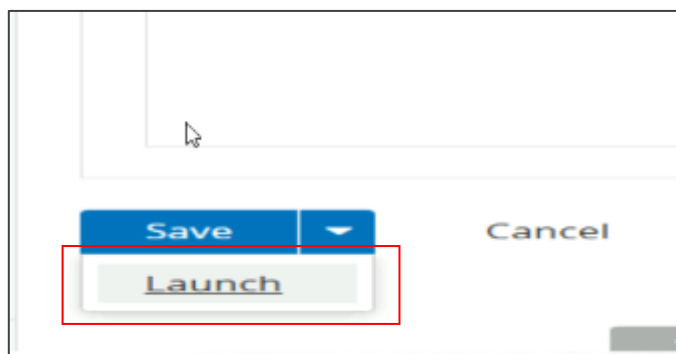
Authentication method: Password

Username: administrator

Password: Password.1!!

Domain:

1.12 Scroll down, click on the drop-down, and select **Launch** to start the scan

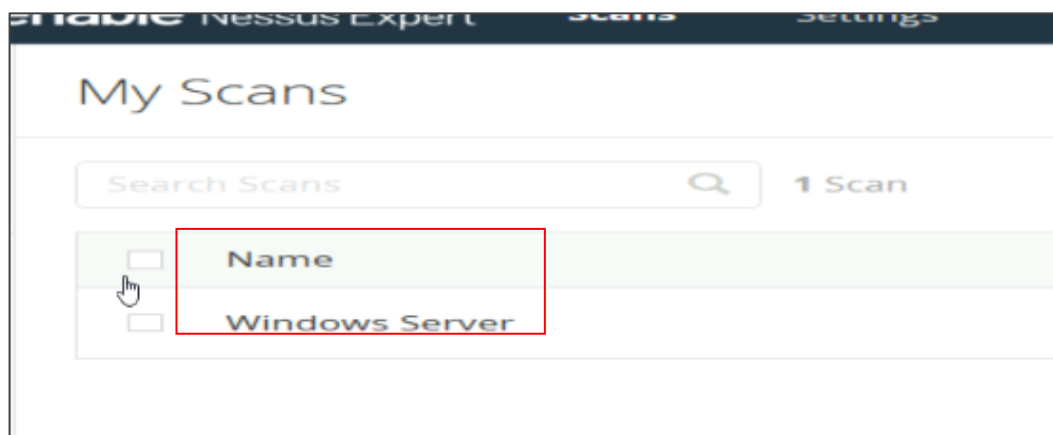


1.13 Wait for the scan to complete

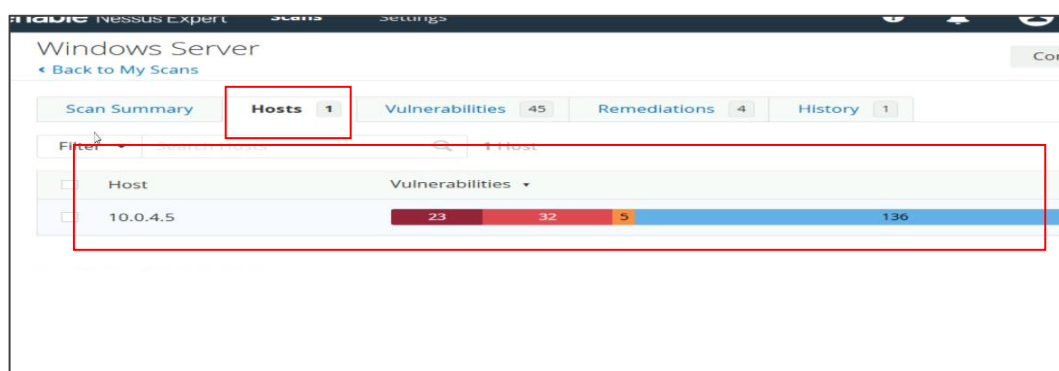
Scans		
Scan Type	Schedule	
Vulnerability	On Demand	

Scan Type	Schedule	Last Scanned
Vulnerability	On Demand	 Today at 1:20 AM

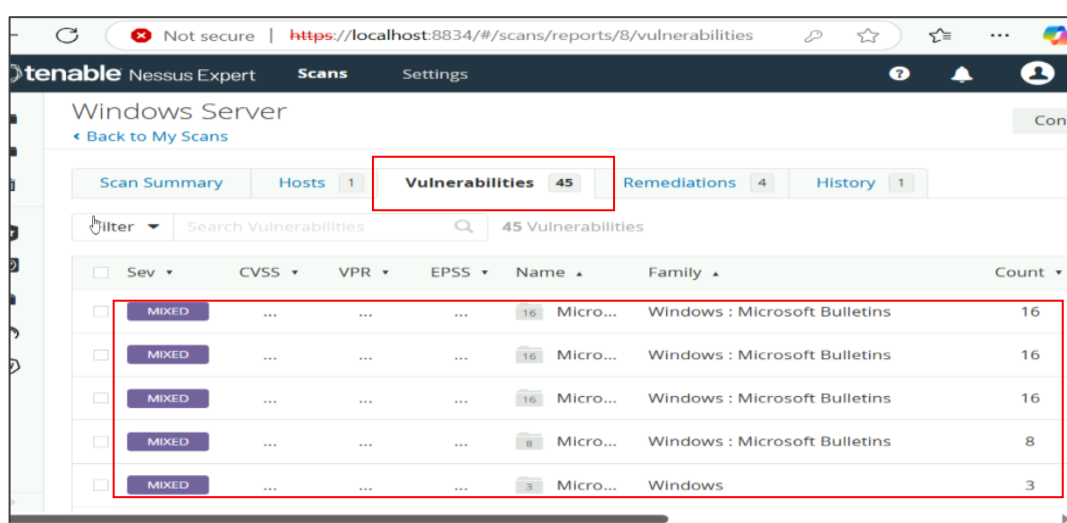
1.14 Once the scan is complete, click on **Windows Server** under My Scans to access the scan results



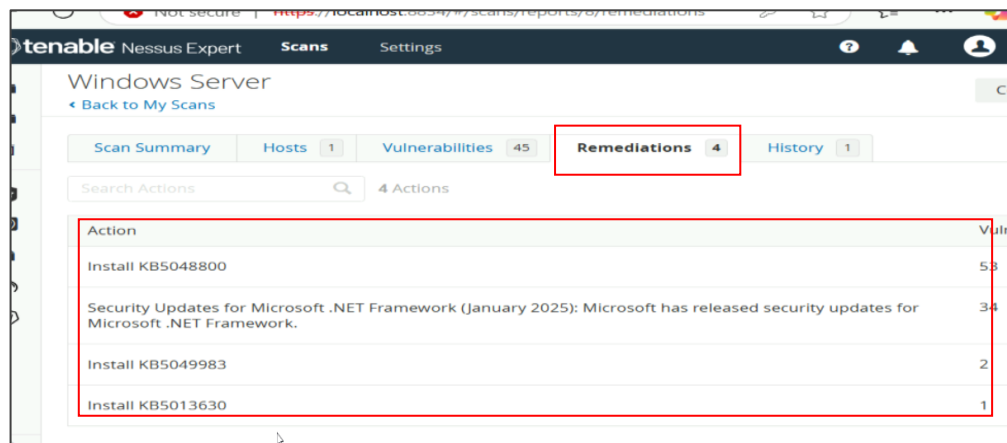
1.15 View detailed information about the scanned host by clicking on **Hosts**



1.16 Analyze the **Vulnerabilities** discovered

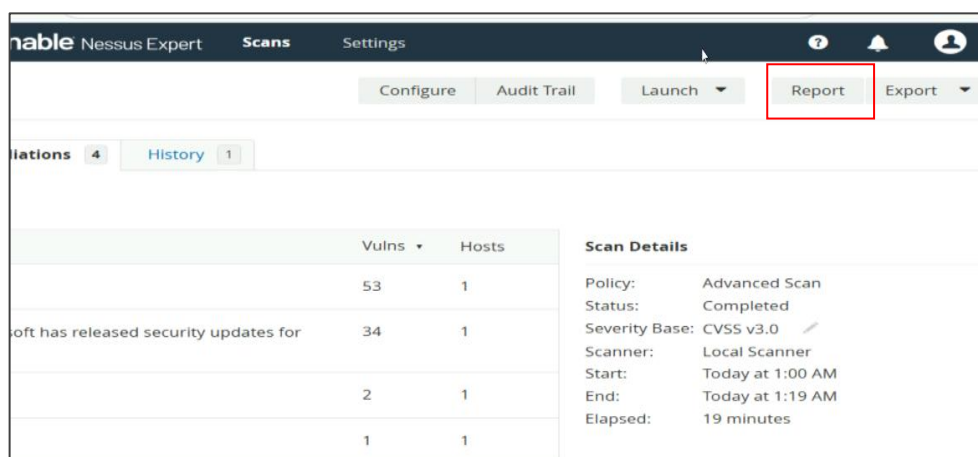


1.17 Access suggested **Remediations** for the detected vulnerabilities

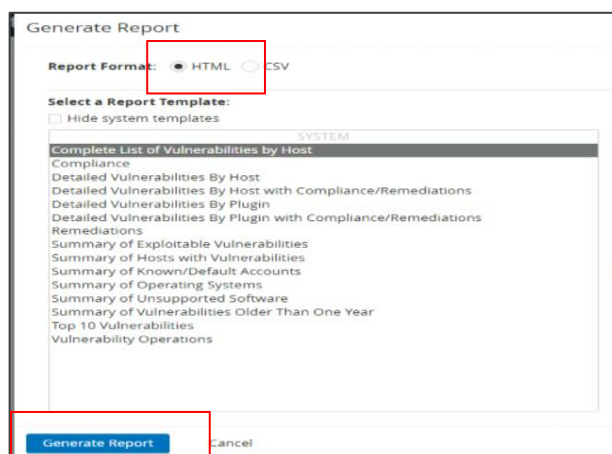


Step 2: Generate the report

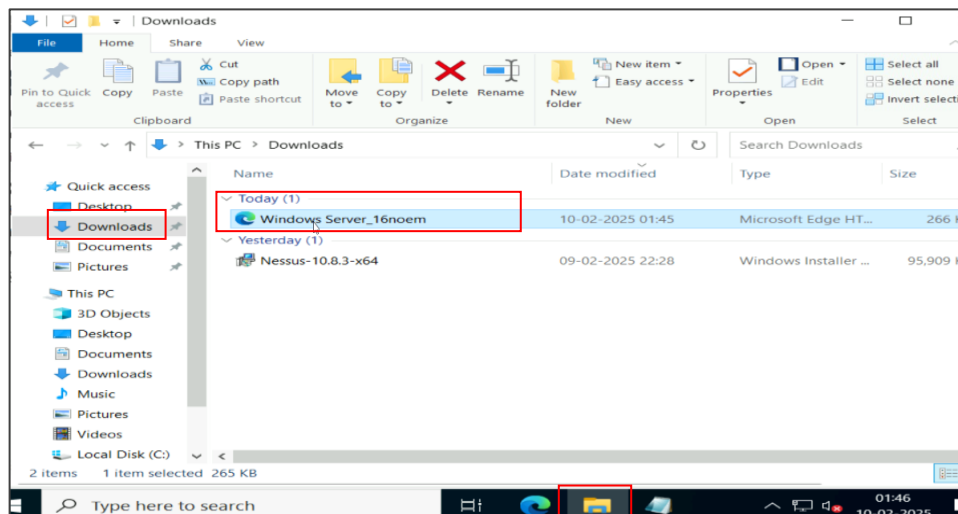
2.1 Navigate to the **Reports** section in Nessus



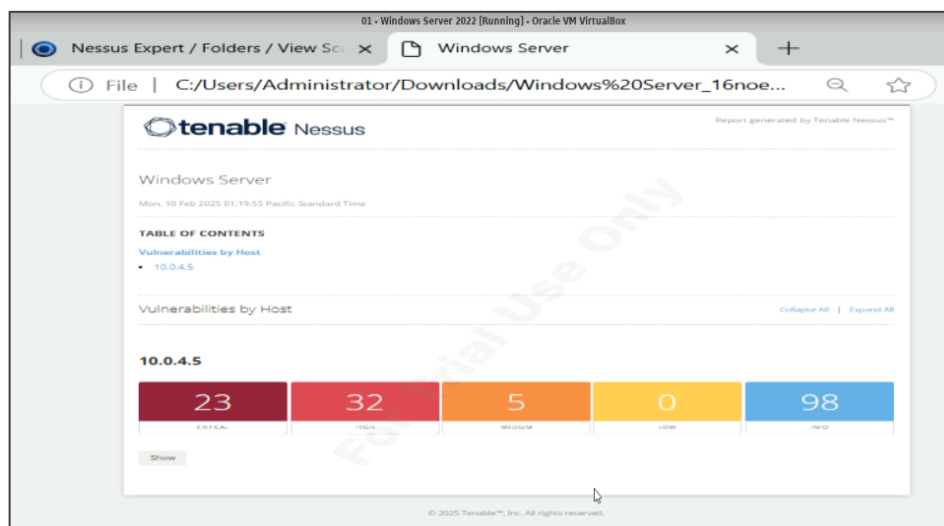
2.2 Select **HTML** as the format and click on **Generate Report**



2.3 Open **File Explorer**, navigate to the **Downloads** folder, and double-click on the downloaded report



2.4 View the findings



By following these steps, you have successfully performed a credentialed scan on a Windows Server using Nessus and generated a detailed vulnerability assessment report. Credentialed scans provide deeper insights by detecting internal vulnerabilities, identifying system-level risks, and offering remediation recommendations to help secure your environment.